```
Client.create_with(locked: false).find_or_create_by(first_name:
'Andy')
```

The second way is using a block:

```
Client.find_or_create_by(first_name: 'Andy') do |c|
  c.locked = false
end
```

The block will only be executed if the client is being created. The second time we run this code, the block will be ignored.

17.2 find_or_create_by!

You can also use `find_or_create_by!` to raise an exception if the new record is invalid. Validations are not covered on this guide, but let's assume for a moment that you temporarily add

```
validates :orders_count, presence: true
```

to your `Client` model. If you try to create a new `Client` without passing an `orders_count`, the record will be invalid and an exception will be raised:

```
Client.find_or_create_by!(first_name: 'Andy')
# => ActiveRecord::RecordInvalid: Validation failed: Orders count
can't be blank
```

17.3 find_or_initialize_by

The `find_or_initialize_by` method will work just like `find_or_create_by` but it will call `new`instead of `create`. This means that a new model instance will be created in memory but won't be saved to the database. Continuing with the `find_or_create_by` example, we now want the client named 'Nick':

```
nick = Client.find_or_initialize_by(first_name: 'Nick')
# => <Client id: nil, first_name: "Nick", orders_count: 0, locked:
true, created_at: "2011-08-30 06:09:27", updated_at: "2011-08-30
06:09:27">

nick.persisted?
# => false

nick.new_record?
# => true
```

Because the object is not yet stored in the database, the SQL generated looks like this:

```
SELECT * FROM clients WHERE (clients.first_name = 'Nick') LIMIT 1
```

When you want to save it to the database, just call `save`:

```
nick.save
# => true
```

18 Finding by SQL

If you'd like to use your own SQL to find records in a table you can use `find_by_sql`.

The `find_by_sql` method will return an array of objects even if the underlying query returns just a single record. For example you could run this query:

```
Client.find_by_sql("SELECT * FROM clients
  INNER JOIN orders ON clients.id = orders.client_id
  ORDER BY clients.created_at desc")
# =>  [
  #<Client id: 1, first_name: "Lucas" >,
  #<Client id: 2, first_name: "Jan" >,
  # ...
]
```

`find_by_sql` provides you with a simple way of making custom calls to the database and retrieving instantiated objects.